

**Blackwood** If you have an agreed suit, you can find out how many Aces (and Kings) partner holds by using a 4NT bid. A reply of 5♣ shows 0 or 4, 5♦ shows 1, 5♥ shows 2 and 5♠ shows 3.

If your side has all four Aces, bidding 5NT will repeat the process for Kings.

The Replier can show one Ace plus a Void by bidding 6 of the Void suit if it ranks below the agreed trump, or 6 of the trump suit if the Void ranks above.

A Reply of 5NT shows two Aces plus a Void in some suit.

**Gerber** : Similar to Blackwood, this convention uses a 4♣ bid to initiate the Ace question, with 4♦ showing 0 or 4, 4♥ showing 1, 4♠ showing 2 and 4NT showing 3.

Not all 4♣ bids are Gerber, and deciding which ones are needs to be addressed by the partnership. For these Deals 4♣ is Gerber only when it follows a bid of 1NT or 2NT.

BakerBridge has complete lessons for these two conventions.

Board: 1  
Dealer: **North**  
Contract: 5♠  
Declarer: North  
Lead: ♦Q

Board: 2  
Dealer: **West**  
Contract: 6♥  
Declarer: East  
Lead: ♣A

Board: 3  
Dealer: **South**  
Contract: 6NT  
Declarer: South  
Lead: ♠4

Board: 4  
Dealer: **East**  
Contract: 7NT  
Declarer: West  
Lead: ♣Q

Board: 5  
Dealer: **South**  
Contract: 5♥  
Declarer: North  
Lead: ♦A

**Board 1**

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 10 5  
 ♥ 8 6 3  
 ♦ 10 9 6 5 4  
 ♣ A 9 6

♠ A K Q 9 8 3

♥ 2

♦ A K

♣ K Q J 8



♠ 6  
 ♥ A J 10 9 7  
 ♦ Q J 7 3  
 ♣ 10 4 2

♠ J 7 4 2

♥ K Q 5 4

♦ 8 2

♣ 7 5 3

SOUTH's 3♠ supporting bid is enough to convince NORTH to make a slam try.

NORTH bids Blackwood 4NT. If SOUTH shows one Ace NORTH plans to bid 6♠, but when SOUTH bids 5♣ NORTH settles for 5♠

| <i>West</i> | <i>North</i> | <i>East</i> | <i>South</i> |
|-------------|--------------|-------------|--------------|
|             | 2♣           | Pass        | 2♦           |
| Pass        | 2♠           | Pass        | 3♠           |
| Pass        | 4NT          | Pass        | 5♣           |
| Pass        | 5♠           |             |              |
| All Pass    |              |             |              |
| 5♠ by North |              |             |              |
| Lead: ♦Q    |              |             |              |

**Board 2**

West Deals

N-S Vul

♠ A 6 4  
♥ K J 9  
♦ A K Q J 9  
♣ K Q

♠ Q 10 2

♥ 5 3 2

♦ 8 2

♣ 9 8 5 3 2



♠ J 3

♥ A Q 10 8 6

♦ 10 3

♣ J 10 7 4

♠ K 9 8 7 5

♥ 7 4

♦ 7 6 5 4

♣ A 6

EAST makes a positive 3♥ response to WEST's 2♣ opener. This promises at least 8 points and a 5-card suit with two or more honors.

WEST only needs to know one thing - how many Aces in the EAST hand. A Blackwood 4NT tells her the answer is one, so she bids 6♥.

| West       | North | East | South |
|------------|-------|------|-------|
| 2♣         | Pass  | 2♥   | Pass  |
| 4NT        | Pass  | 5♦   | Pass  |
| 6♥         |       |      |       |
| All Pass   |       |      |       |
| 6♥ by East |       |      |       |
| Lead: ♣A   |       |      |       |

**Board 3**

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ J 6 5 4 2

♥ 9 8 7

♦ 10 5 2

♣ 6 4

♠ K Q

♥ K 6

♦ A 4

♣ K Q J 9 7 3 2



♠ 10 8 3

♥ A 10 5 3

♦ J 9 7 3

♣ 10 8

♠ A 9 7

♥ Q J 4 2

♦ K Q 8 6

♣ A 5

When SOUTH opens 1NT, point-count alone tells NORTH that 6NT can surely be made. SOUTH is bound to hold at least two Aces. But NORTH doesn't want to miss a Grand slam.

NORTH bids 4♣, (Gerber), and SOUTH admits to just two Aces.

So NORTH settles for the small slam.

| <i>West</i>  | <i>North</i> | <i>East</i> | <i>South</i> |
|--------------|--------------|-------------|--------------|
|              |              |             | 1NT          |
| Pass         | 4♣           | Pass        | 4♠           |
| Pass         | 6NT          |             |              |
| All Pass     |              |             |              |
| 6NT by South |              |             |              |
| Lead: ♠4     |              |             |              |

**Board 4**

East Deals

Both Vul

♠ A K Q 6 4 3

♥ K 5

♦ K 7 3

♣ A K

♠ 8

♥ Q 10

♦ J 9 6 5 4 2

♣ Q J 3 2

|   |   |   |
|---|---|---|
|   | N |   |
| W |   | E |
|   | S |   |

♠ J 9 5 2

♥ A J 7 4 3

♦ A Q

♣ 9 8

♠ 10 7

♥ 9 8 6 2

♦ 10 8

♣ 10 7 6 5 4

WEST has a powerhouse and knows she will reach a slam somewhere. When EAST supports the ♠s, it seems she has found her spot.

Blackwood tells her that EAST has two Aces. She can see there are 12 tricks available and decides to take a chance that EAST will have a thirteenth trick somewhere among his opening hand points.

She bids 7NT.

| West        | North | East | South |
|-------------|-------|------|-------|
|             |       | 1♥   | Pass  |
| 2♠          | Pass  | 3♠   | Pass  |
| 4NT         | Pass  | 5♥   | Pass  |
| 7NT         |       |      |       |
| All Pass    |       |      |       |
| 7NT by West |       |      |       |
| Lead: ♣Q    |       |      |       |

**Board 5**

South Deals

N-S Vul

♠ Q 10 6 5

♥ 7 2

♦ 10 9 5

♣ A 9 7 2

♠ J 7 3

♥ A J 10 9 8

♦ 8 3 2

♣ Q 8



♠ 9 8 4

♥ 4 3

♦ A 7 6 4

♣ 10 5 4 3

♠ A K 2

♥ K Q 6 5

♦ K Q J

♣ K J 6

SOUTH is tempted to go right to 6♥ when she hears NORTH's positive response. BUT, she should use Blackwood first.

It's good thing she did because NORTH admits to only one Ace - they are missing two Aces.

*West**North**East**South*

2♣

Pass

2♥

Pass

4NT

Pass

5♦

Pass

5♥

All Pass

5♥ by North

Lead: ♦A